

Board 1

West Deals
None Vul

♠ 8
♥ A K 7 6 4
♦ Q J T 8 4
♣ A 8

♠ J T 6 4
♥ Q
♦ A K 9 6 5 2
♣ K T

N

W

E

S

♠ A K Q 5
♥ 5 3
♦ 7 3
♣ J 9 6 3 2

♠ 9 7 3 2
♥ J T 9 8 2
♦ -
♣ Q 7 5 4

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	2 ♦	Dbl	
All Pass			
2 ♦ by North			

The bidding has been as shown.

Partner has 10+ points, a ♠ suit and fewer than 3 ♥s. Doesn't this look like the perfect hand to pass for penalties? Yes.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A T 9 6
♥ K Q J 6
♦ 9 3 2
♣ K 8

♠ J 5 4 3 2

♥ A 8 2

♦ J 6

♣ 7 6 4



♠ K 8 7
♥ T 5 3
♦ A Q T
♣ A T 9 3

♠ Q

♥ 9 7 4

♦ K 8 7 5 4

♣ Q J 5 2

West

North

East

South

Dbl

Pass

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

The bidding has been as shown.

This is one of the nicer parts of Negative Doubles. When the bidding is 1♣ - 1♦, a double by you promises both Majors. It's like you are allowed to bid both suits at once, 1♠♥. So you double and partner says 1NT.

Partner doesn't have 4 of either Major. But he does have 13 points and ♦s stopped. You also have 13 points so you bid 3NT.

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8 6
 ♥ Q T 7
 ♦ A 8 7 6 3
 ♣ 7 3 2

♠ J 7 3

♥ 5 3

♦ K Q J T 4

♣ A J 6



♠ A 5 2
 ♥ K J 9 4 2
 ♦ 2
 ♣ Q 9 8 5

♠ K Q T 9 4

♥ A 8 6

♦ 9 5

♣ K T 4

West

North

East

South

1♦

1♥

1♠

Pass

2♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by South

The bidding has been as shown.

It is the sign of a novice to support responder's 1-level response with only 3 of the suit. Very often he will have responded in a 4-card suit and you end up playing in a 7-card fit.

But that is not the case here. If partner had only 4 ♠s he would not have bid the suit, he would have made a Negative Double. Since his ♠ bid promises 5 it is quite correct for you to support with only 3. So you raise to 2 ♠ and partner bids the game.

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q
 ♥ K
 ♦ Q J T 9 4
 ♣ A J 7 4 3 2

♠ 9 6 3
 ♥ T 5 2
 ♦ A 2
 ♣ K Q T 8 6



♠ J T 8 4 2
 ♥ Q J 7 6 4
 ♦ 7 5 3
 ♣ -

♠ A K 7 5
 ♥ A 9 8 3
 ♦ K 8 6
 ♣ 9 5

West	North	East	South
2♣	Pass	Pass	1♦
All Pass			Dbl
2♣ by West			

The bidding has been as shown.

First let's agree on what you **DON'T** say. You don't say "double" because that would be a Negative Double showing at least one 4-card Major. You don't support partner's ♦s with just two of them. You probably don't bid 1NT with no honor in either Major. So you pass. This is called a "Trap Pass". Partner re-opens with a double.

Now you see why it's called a "Trap Pass". When an overcall is followed by two passes Opener should try to find another bid. In particular he should try to double for takeout if he can. That's what South did here, but you converted it to a Penalty Double by passing.